Marvel Sales Argumentarium

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Status	draft for team review
Source	Team 1 authored fictional Marvel CPG document (fictional company documents are permitted by the capstone brief and the official client clarifications); evidence from the project dataset and the Team 1 V3 EDA

Marvel CPG is a fictional company created for the University at Buffalo CDA 650 capstone. This document was written by Team 1 for the project's RAG knowledge base. Figures marked data *come from the project dataset; everything else is fictional business content.*

1 How to use this argumentarium

This document gives field representatives the selling stories for Marvel's categories, the degreaser line, and each channel. Every argument is built on a fact the rep can show: a price from the product master, or a figure from the project dataset (marked *data*). Use it together with the objection-handling guide (MCPG-04) and the product sheets (MCPG-01).

Three rules for every conversation:

1. **Lead with the store's own business**: availability, sales and margin on its shelf.
2. **Quote only figures you can trace** to this document or the dashboard. If a number is not here, do not invent it.
3. **Never promise an execution uplift figure.** In Marvel's data, secondary displays, planogram compliance and shelf share show at most about a 1% sales difference for the same store and SKU. That is too small to promise. Sell execution on visibility and on what the account receives in return (MCPG-05), not on a guaranteed sales increase.

2 The Marvel story in one minute

- **A complete household-cleaning range from one supplier**: 23 SKUs across Surface Cleaners, Dishwashing and Laundry, under six brands.
- **Shoppers buy it.** *(data)* In the 17 months to May 2026, Marvel products generated about $70.6 million of consumer sales value in the 221 accounts. Laundry was 40% of that value, Surface Cleaners 32% and Dishwashing 28%.
- **The retailer earns a healthy margin.** At the reference consumer price, a retailer buying at list price keeps 23% to 28% of the shelf price before any trade discount (MCPG-01, section 5).
- **Availability is the biggest lever.** *(data)* Small accounts are out of stock far more often: 15.1% of store-days in Tier 3, against 2.9% in Tier 1. Fixing availability is the fastest way to grow sales on the same shelf.

3 Facts that work in every category

3.1 Availability sells

(data) Over January 2025 to May 2026, an estimated 4.8% of potential sales were lost to empty shelves, valued at list price at about $2.7 million. The loss is concentrated in small accounts: about 2.5% of potential sales in Tier 1, 6.5% in Tier 2 and 13.8% in Tier 3 (Team 1 V3 EDA, section 8.1). Stock-outs also last: the median stock-out runs 4 days, and one in ten lasts more than 17 days.

3.2 Promotions bring extra units

(data) On promotion days a store-SKU sells on average 12.9% more units than on normal days in the same month, at an average discount of 11%. By promotion type: BOGO +23%, Volume deals +20%, TPR (temporary price reduction) +15%, Feature +13%, Display +11%, Bundle +2%. Details and the calendar are in MCPG-07.

3.3 Weekends and seasons

(data) Shoppers buy about 22% more on Saturdays and Sundays than on weekdays, in every channel, so the shelf must be full by Friday. Each category has its own season:

- **Surface Cleaners:** spring cleaning. March and April run 11% to 18% above the average month, and July and August about 15% below.
- **Laundry:** higher in January and September, lowest in July.
- **Dishwashing:** the steadiest category, with a high point in November and December.

(Seasonal indexes from non-promotion days, Team 1 V3 EDA section 6.2.)

4 Category selling stories

4.1 Surface Cleaners: "one range for every surface job"

- Lead with the **Power Clean 1 L** pair (Lemon and Original), both MSL. They are interchangeable, which makes them easy to keep in stock (MCPG-02).
- Add the **Heavy-Duty Degreaser** for kitchens and workshops, the **Glass & Surface Spray** for shine, and **Multi-Surface Wipes** for convenience.
- Time the shelf to the spring peak: stock up for March and April and for the Spring Clean Blitz TPR (12% off Surface Cleaners in Modern and Traditional Trade, 3 to 23 March in both 2025 and 2026; MCPG-07).
- *(data)* The Degreaser 1 L is the #1 Surface Cleaner by consumer sales value (18.9% of the category), ahead of the Multi-Surface Wipes (15.6%) and Power Clean Lemon (14.5%).

4.2 Dishwashing: "the steady earner"

- The **Dishwasher Pods 45ct** is the #2 SKU in the whole portfolio by value and 30% of Dishwashing value *(data)*. Make sure it never runs out.
- The three 28 oz hand dish soaps (Citrus, Original, Antibacterial) are all MSL and substitute for each other (MCPG-02).
- Demand is steady all year, so Dishwashing is the easiest category to plan. Use the Holiday Bundle (November) and the Traditional Trade Support feature (April) for extra visibility.

4.3 Laundry: "the biggest basket"

- Laundry is the largest category (40% of consumer sales value) and holds two of the top three SKUs: **Laundry Pods 42ct** (#1 in the portfolio) and **Laundry Detergent HE 100oz** (#3) *(data)*.
- Offer both formats: liquid for value per load and pods for convenience. Keep the smaller packs (Pods 20ct, HE 50oz) as entry options.
- Push stock ahead of the January and September peaks and the October Traditional Trade Support TPR (8% off Laundry).

5 The Marvel Pro Heavy-Duty Degreaser line

The degreaser line is two SKUs: the **Heavy-Duty Degreaser 1L** (SKU-1004, MSL) and the **Heavy-Duty Degreaser 500ml** (SKU-1005, optional). It is the heavy-duty option in Surface Cleaners for grease and baked-on grime on stovetops, range hoods, oven exteriors and grills (MCPG-01, sections 2.4 and 2.5).

Why a store should carry it *(data unless stated)*:

1. **It is already the category leader.** The 1 L is the #1 Surface Cleaner by consumer sales value (18.9% of the category, #4 of 23 in the whole portfolio).
2. **It earns the most per unit sold.** At $5.80 list and $8.07 reference shelf price, the 1 L is the highest-priced Surface Cleaner. Each unit sold brings the store more value than any other product in the category. At the reference shelf price the retailer keeps about 28% before trade discounts.
3. **The 500 ml sells as fast as the 1 L.** Where it is stocked, the 500 ml sells about the same number of units per in-stock day as the 1 L: about 9.8 vs 9.7 units a day in Tier 1 accounts, 4.7 vs 4.6 in Tier 2 and 1.9 in both in Tier 3. It is a low-price entry pack ($3.50 list) that does not slow the shelf.

4. **There is room to grow.** The 500 ml is carried by only 128 of 221 accounts, and by just 20 of the 65 Tier 3 accounts. The 1 L is MSL and should be in every account.

5. **It has a season.** Surface Cleaners peak in March and April, and the Spring Clean Blitz (12% off in March) covers the whole category in Modern and Traditional Trade.

Suggested pitch by account type:

- **Tier 1 and Modern Trade:** both sizes side by side. The 1 L for regular buyers and the 500 ml as a trial pack, ideally with a secondary display during the spring peak.
- **Tier 2 and Tier 3 / Traditional Trade:** start with the 1 L (it is MSL), add the 500 ml as one facing. Agree a reorder point so the line does not run out (MCPG-04, section 2.8).
- **Distributors:** include both sizes in the next volume order, timed to the Distributor Volume Deal periods (MCPG-07).

6 Channel stories

6.1 Modern Trade (supermarkets and chains)

- Talk category management: complete range, planogram compliance and visibility.
- Modern Trade has the strongest execution base *(data)*: planogram compliance of 95% in Tier 1 accounts, and the lowest stock-out rate of the three channels (6.7%).
- Use the promotion calendar (Spring Clean Blitz, Summer Refresh, Back to School, Fall Cleaning Event BOGO, Holiday Bundle, Modern Trade Exclusive) to plan displays and orders together.

6.2 Traditional Trade (neighbourhood and convenience stores)

- Talk availability and simplicity: the MSL SKUs first, then one or two extra facings.
- Deliveries take longer and are less punctual in this channel *(data)*: a median 5 days from order to arrival, and 24% of deliveries arrive late. Help the store order before the shelf is empty.
- Traditional Trade is invoiced about every two weeks, so compare orders with sales over the same two-week window (MCPG-08).

6.3 Distributors (wholesale accounts)

- Distributors are wholesale accounts that resell to smaller stores. Talk volume, assortment breadth and the volume-deal calendar, not shelf execution.
- Volume deals give 14% off with a minimum of 200 units, in two windows a year (Q1: about 20 January to 2 March; Q3 2025: 14 July to 24 August). Trade discount limits are in MCPG-05.

7 What not to claim

- **No execution uplift numbers.** Do not tell an account that a display, a planogram fix or extra shelf share will raise sales by a set percentage. The data does not support a figure larger than about 1% (Team 1 V3 EDA, section 8.7).
- **No competitor comparisons.** The project has no competitor data, so do not quote competitor prices, shares or performance.
- **No product claims beyond the label.** Do not add germ-kill rates, "safe for all surfaces" or medical claims (MCPG-01, PUB-03).
- **No approvals.** A rep cannot approve a discount above the account's cap. See MCPG-05 for what needs manager review.

Document control

Item	Value
Document	MCPG-03, version 1.0.0
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Owner	Team 1 knowledge base (Sanika Najan)

Item	Value
Status	Draft for team review
Source	Product master dim_products and promotion calendar dim_promotions
Source	Project dataset: Authorized V3 dataset (dataset hash f5403651d8aa...), reported sell-out rows 1 Jan 2025 - 31 May 2026; June 2026 held out
Source	Team 1 V3 EDA (notebook 01_v3_eda): sections 6.2 (seasonality), 6.4 (weekdays), 8.1 (stock-outs and lost sales), 8.5 (promotions), 8.7 (execution)

Open points and review notes

- The client brief calls it 'the new degreaser line'. In the data, both degreaser SKUs sell from January 2025, so 'new' here means new to an account's shelf.
- The client described a built-in execution uplift (display +8%, planogram +5%, shelf share +3% per 10 points). The data shows at most about 1%, so this guide does not use those figures until the difference is explained.